Irena Grocka

Lead Quality Engineer | AI in Quality Engineering

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KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

17x	**1,700**	**Org-wide**	**4**
automation coverage growth	Playwright tests	AI tooling adoption	direct reports, 2 senior

PROFILE

Lead Quality Engineer with 9+ years across enterprise programmes and SaaS product teams, combining hands-on automation engineering with people leadership and ownership of quality strategy. At Preservica I line-manage four engineers across feature squads and the automation team and own the test automation strategy behind a Playwright suite that has **grown from roughly 100 tests to 1,700**. As the function's AI Champion I started the QE AI initiative from scratch, authored the organisation's AI-Powered QE Strategy, and shipped production AI tooling now adopted across the organisation. I hire and grow QE talent, interview up to Lead level, and report quality and adoption metrics to engineering leadership.

CORE SKILLS

Quality Leadership	Line management & 1:1s · Career development and coaching · Test & automation strategy · Risk-based testing · Quality governance & sign-off · Release and regression management · Test metrics and leadership reporting · Code review · Stakeholder management · Agile/Scrum · SDLC/STLC · Shift-left quality
Test Automation	Playwright (TypeScript) · Visual regression testing · Accessibility testing · Cypress · Page Object Model · API & contract testing (Postman, REST Assured, Pact Broker) · CI/CD pipelines (TeamCity, CircleCI, Bitbucket Pipelines) · Git / Bitbucket / GitHub
AI in Quality Engineering	AI adoption strategy & governance · Claude Code skill and agent authoring · Model Context Protocol (MCP) · Anthropic Claude API · Prompt engineering · AI-assisted test generation, test data creation, maintenance and triage · AI artefact cataloguing and sign-off
Engineering	TypeScript · JavaScript · Node.js / Express · React · Python · Docker · AWS (ECS Fargate, S3, ALB) · REST APIs · OpenAPI/Swagger · Microservices
Tooling	Testmo · TestRail · Jira · Confluence · Postman · Sentry · Looker · Figma

EXPERIENCE

Preservica — Lead Quality Engineer & QE AI Champion

May 2025 – Present · Remote, UK

Digital preservation SaaS. Line-manage four quality engineers embedded across feature squads and the automation team, owning test automation strategy and the organisation's QE AI programme.

- **Own the test automation strategy** behind the Playwright suite's growth from roughly **100 tests to 1,700** since I joined — personally extending the estate into **visual regression and accessibility testing** and significantly expanding automated coverage across the product, running in TypeScript through TeamCity and Bitbucket.
- **Line-manage four quality engineers — two of them senior — embedded across feature squads and the automation team**, covering 1:1s, objective setting, career progression and technical development. **Hired two test engineers and interviewed at Lead level as part of the hiring panel**, helping set and hold the bar for QE hiring.
- **Started the QE AI initiative from scratch while carrying full quality ownership for a feature squad**, then **authored and took ownership of the AI-Powered QE Strategy 2026** — the organisation's operating model for AI in quality, covering AI integration at each SDLC stage, shared capabilities (test data, coverage, performance, release risk) and continuous learning from escaped defects. Selected into the company-wide AI Champions group on the strength of this work.
- **All QE AI initiatives and tooling sit under my ownership.** Designed the four-tier governance framework and five-stage solution lifecycle used to approve every QE AI tool — including mandatory security review and Head of Engineering sign-off at infrastructure tier — against measurable targets of **–30% test creation time, –40% triage preparation, –20% requirement-related defects and +15% automation coverage.**
- **Direct a portfolio of AI tooling delivered by the team** — delegating and supervising build and sign-off of the Playwright Test Console, Jira Ticket Review Assistant, Manual Test Case Generator and Regression Phase Planner — and coordinated rollout and structured feedback across five product squads: Access & Control, Enrich, Search & Discover, Store & Preserve and Capture & Ingest.
- **Built and shipped the Bug Reporting Agent**, a production web app (React, Node.js/Express, Claude API, Jira REST v3) on AWS ECS Fargate — guided bug capture with AI-drafted descriptions, automated duplicate detection and severity recommendation. **Adopted across the organisation** over four releases.

- **Authored four organisation-wide Claude Code skills** for the Playwright estate — recording-to-test, manual-case-to-test, coverage gap analysis and API test generation from OpenAPI/Swagger — plus **AI-driven test data generation** tooling. **Coverage gap analysis reduced from roughly half a day to 15–30 minutes per feature area.**

Apply Digital — Quality Engineer
Mar 2023 – May 2025 · London

- Designed and implemented the **Playwright automation framework** for a major eCommerce client, establishing the structure, conventions and CI integration the team built on.
- Introduced **consumer-driven contract testing with Pact Broker** across a microservices estate on AWS, delivering the proof of concept and the documentation that made it repeatable for other teams.
- Ran the tooling evaluation for backend testing (Postman, SOAP UI, ReadyAPI, REST Assured, Playwright, Cypress) and produced the recommendation and PoC adopted as the team standard; established processes for bug recording, triage and analytics, plus testing guidelines for payments and group testing.
- Tested the integration of **Constructor.io** machine-learning search as the primary search solution for a major eCommerce platform. Early adopter of AI for test case creation, automation and bug reporting.

Pendo.io — Senior Quality Engineer
Feb 2022 – Mar 2023 · Sheffield

- Delivered the **Validate** feedback-platform migration: first beta completed **ahead of schedule** with the **regression pack automated to 85%**, and the open beta **exceeded its 100-customer target by 300%.**
- Delivered **nine legacy-feedback projects** to time and budget, integrating with Pendo Guides and Segments and third-party platforms including Salesforce, Jira and Zendesk.
- Set testing strategy for feature teams, mitigating delivery risk across interdependent product areas and aligning approach between teams.
- Reviewed automated test code and coached junior engineers on Cypress best practice; authored the quality, risk-management and automation practice documentation as part of the cross-functional Tiger team.

Pendo.io — Quality Engineer
May 2020 – Jan 2022 · Sheffield

- Built and maintained automated sanity and regression suites in **Cypress**, debugging and resolving automation failures.
- Owned and led execution of the team's releases, coordinating code releases through **CircleCI**; closed gaps in test coverage and process, and monitored customer-reported bugs and major incidents through to remediation.

Wilko — Senior Test Analyst
Jul 2019 – Apr 2020 · Worksop

- **Supervised a team of up to 10 onshore and offshore testers**, owning test coverage, user-story analysis and review of script creation and execution; mentored junior members of the test function.
- Defined and implemented the **company test strategy**, test plans, defect lifecycle procedures and automation strategy.
- Led finance-stream testing for the **SAP S/4HANA migration** and GK Retail EPOS upgrade, validating data integrity and business processes across System, System Integration and UAT phases.
- Compiled and reported test metrics to senior stakeholders using **HP ALM 11/12.5** (administrator); built the SAP regression pack with testing partners using **UFT**.

Wilko — Test Analyst → Junior Test Analyst
Apr 2017 – Jul 2019 · Worksop

- Delivered functional, integration and UAT testing across SAP and retail EPOS programmes; supported offshore test teams and helped build the test process and metrics framework adopted company-wide.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **ISEB/ISTQB Foundation & Intermediate Certificate in Software Testing** — 2018
- **AWS Partner: Accreditation (Technical)** — 2023
- **SheCodes** — project-based front-end development programme — 2024
- **PhD, Chemistry** (2007–2013) and **MSc General Chemistry, Distinction** (2002–2007) — University of Wrocław. Doctoral research into ferrocene subunits in macrocyclic porphyrin structures, published in peer-reviewed journals.